foreign missionaries for ‘undesirable activities’. When he was questioned, Katju declared that the expelled missionaries had ‘moved about among the primitive tribes and indulged in various activities which from the national point of view were not considered satisfactory’.[22]

Congress ministers from five states added to this narrative. The Madras state government, headed by former governor general of India, C. Rajagopalachari, sent the Home Ministry a report on ‘anti-Indian’ activities by two Italian missionaries in Fort Cochin.[23] Assam Chief Minister Bishnuram Medhi accused the American Baptist Mission of ‘abetting a foreign conspiracy to separate the Naga Hills from India and to retain it as an imperialist foothold’.[24] UP Home Minister Sampurnanand too announced that he was consulting with the Central government about ‘concerns’ on American missionaries who, he said, had become particularly active in rural areas and on the state’s borders with Tibet and Nepal. The UP assembly’s deputy speaker, Hargovind Patel, alleged that some of these missionaries carried ‘wireless transmitters’.[25] The UP assembly separately discussed a dispute on 250 conversions in Mathura by Catholic and Methodist missionaries, which led to the arrest of Arya Samaj activists who alleged ‘monetary inducements’.[26] A minister from Bihar told the States Council that if Christian missionaries continued their ‘wrongful activities’, his state government would force them to leave.[27] With a number of MPs now asking questions linking espionage with foreign missionaries, Home Minister Katju informed the Rajya Sabha that he had begun collecting data on the number of missionaries in Kashmir (his office had counted nine thus far).[28]

Ravishankar Shukla’s Madhya Pradesh government too sent a critical report on ‘objectionable activities’ to Delhi. It alleged, Katju told Parliament, that some missionaries were engaged in ‘anti-Indian movements’, such as the ‘formation of a separate “Jharkhand State” to be affiliated with Pakistan’.[29] Jharkhand, of course, was founded five decades later in 2000 by the BJP-led Vajpayee government (and had nothing to do with Pakistan). Such was the paranoia at the time that Katju formally warned foreign missionaries that India was not